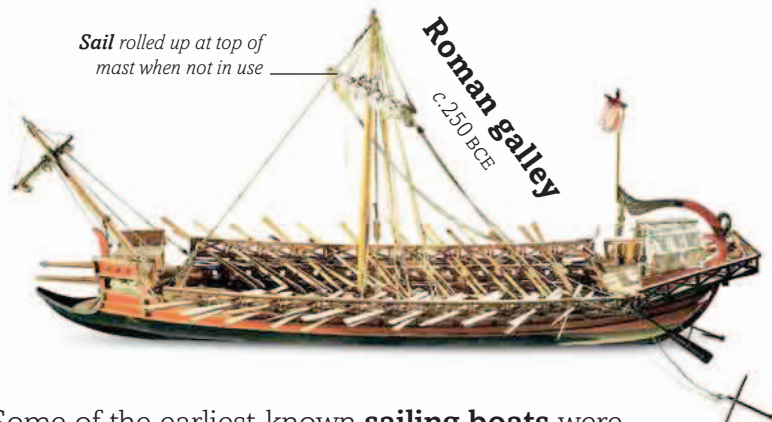
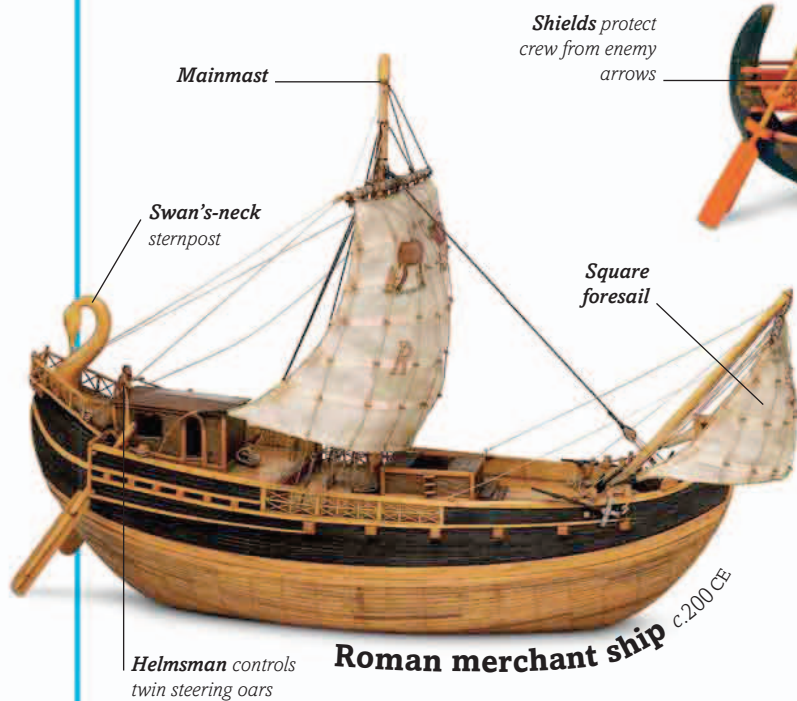
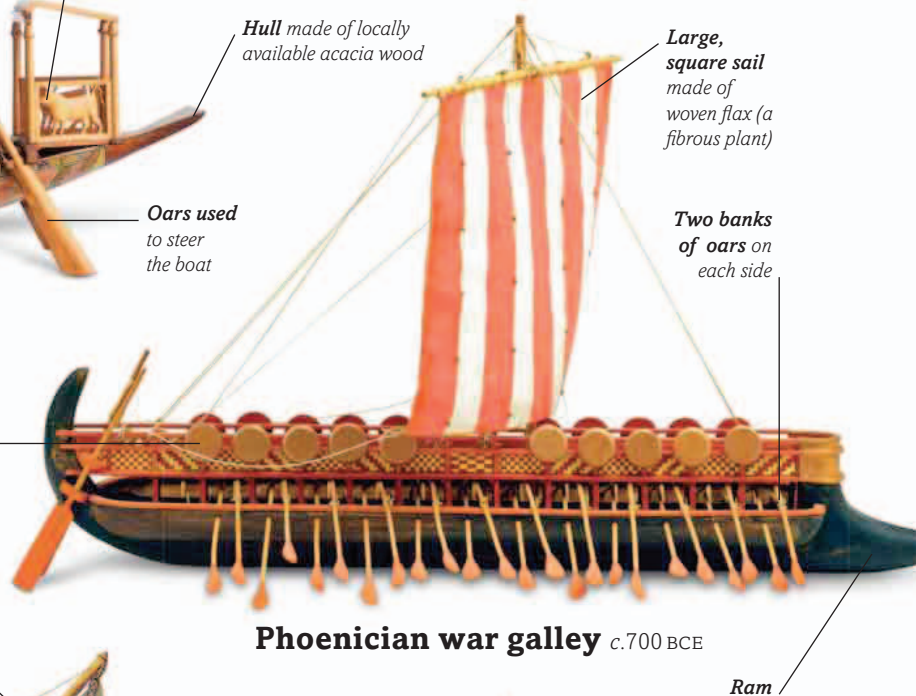




Sail power



Thousands of years ago, people learned to harness the power of the wind to push their craft through the water. Sails made of cloth, reeds, or matting, and hung from a mast, caught the wind to move boats faster than people could row or paddle.

Some of the earliest-known **sailing boats** were found on the Nile River in Egypt, more than 5,000 years ago. They used a large, square sail made of cloth, which worked best when sailing downwind (with wind coming from behind the boat). Square sails were also invented independently in parts of